

an incident of such magnitude and interest would leave no trace of itself in history.¹

It will not do for someone to say that the argument from silence proves nothing. In a matter of this ‘magnitude and interest’ it is conclusive. Sir Frederick G. Kenyon, also, found this part of Hort’s theory to be gratuitous.

The absence of evidence points the other way; for it would be very strange, if Lucian had really edited both Testaments, that only his work on the Old Testament should be mentioned in after times. **The same argument tells against any theory of a deliberate revision at any definite moment** [emphasis added]. We know the names of several revisers of the Septuagint and the Vulgate, and it would be strange if historians and Church writers had all omitted to record or mention such an event as the deliberate revision of the New Testament in its original Greek.²

Come now, is there anything mysterious about what Burgon and Kenyon stated? Is it not obvious? Please stop and think about it for a minute. The silence of history ‘must be held to be fatal to the hypothesis’. Selah.

And then there is the matter of ‘supply and demand’. Those who catalog NT MSS inform us that the 12th and 13th centuries lead the pack, in terms of extant MSS, followed by the 14th, 11th, 15th, 16th and 10th, in that order. There are over four times as many MSS from the 13th as from the 10th, but obviously Koine Greek would have been more of a living language in the 10th than the 13th, and so there would have been more demand and therefore more supply. In other words, many hundreds of really pure MSS from the 10th perished. A higher percentage of the really good MSS produced in the 14th century survived than those produced in the 11th; and so on. That is why there is a progressive level of agreement among the Byzantine MSS, there being a higher percentage of agreement in the 14th than in the 10th. But had we lived in the 10th, and done a wide survey of the MSS, we would have found very nearly the same level of agreement (perhaps 98%). The same obtains if we had lived in the 8th, 6th, 4th or 2nd century. In other words, THE SURVIVING MSS FROM THE FIRST

¹ J.W. Burgon, *The Revision Revised* (London: John Murray, 1883), p. 293.

² F.G. Kenyon, *Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the Greek Bible*, 2nd ed. (Grand Rapids: Wm. B. Eerdmans Publishing Co., 1951), pp. 324-25. Whereas Burgon was a staunch defender of the Traditional Text of the NT, Kenyon most certainly was not, being an advocate of the so-called ‘critical text’.